

# Cliff Bates

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## EXECUTIVE IT LEADER

Strategic, execution-driven Executive Vice President with 25+ years of IT leadership in top-50 U.S. banking. Proven track record directing sizeable budgets, leading global teams of 250+, and driving core banking modernizations, active/active data center resilience, and enterprise-wide cyber vulnerability remediation. Trusted advisor to C-suite and board-level executives, specializing in aligning IT strategy with operational agility, risk mitigation, and regulatory compliance.

Executive IT Leader offering 25+ years of experience in enterprise infrastructure transformation, cyber risk mitigation, and high-performance team building for a forward-looking organization.

## Executive Core Competencies

- **Strategic Leadership:** Enterprise IT Strategy & Vision, Board & Executive Alignment, Global & Offshore Talent Leadership, AI & Emerging Technology Governance
- **Operations & Financials:** P&L / Budget Management, Strategic Vendor & Contract Management (IBM, Microsoft, ServiceNow, TCS, Splunk, Oracle, etc.), Active/Active Multi-Site Data Center Resilience, High-Availability Infrastructure
- **Risk & Security:** Cyber Vulnerability Remediation, Information Security & Cyber Defense, Regulatory Compliance & Examination Defense (FDIC/FFIEC/GLBA), DR & Business Continuity
- **Modernization & Governance:** Core Systems Transformation (TCS BaNCS), Enterprise Architecture, Risk Management & Audit Governance, Crisis & Incident Management

## Executive Leadership & Experience

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### 03/2025 – Present Executive Career Transition & Professional Development

Undertook an intentional sabbatical focused on strategic executive networking, global travel, and staying abreast of emerging enterprise technology trends prior to market re-entry.

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### 12/2017 – 03/2025 Executive Vice President, IT Director - Zions Bancorporation — Salt Lake City, UT

- **Enterprise Operations:** Directed enterprise IT infrastructure operations, technology governance, and data center strategy supporting 450+ financial locations and 20,000+ technology components.
- **Financial Stewardship:** Managed a substantial annual operating budget, optimizing cost structures and vendor licensing efficiency while maintaining continuous high availability.
- **Data Center Resilience:** Architectural leader behind transforming Zions' infrastructure from active/passive to an active/active multi-data center model, achieving non-disruptive uptime.
- **Cyber Vulnerability Remediation:** Spearheaded enterprise-wide patching and threat mitigation across 20,000+ components in close partnership with corporate cybersecurity teams.
- **Audit & Governance:** Deployed a risk management governance framework across 200+ staff, producing measurable audit rating improvements across enterprise environments.

### 03/2013 – 12/2017 Senior Vice President, Core Technical Readiness - Zions Bancorporation — Salt Lake City, UT

- **Core Banking Modernization:** Partnered with the Enterprise CIO to execute Releases 1 & 2 of the multi-year FutureCore TCS BaNCS deployment.
- **Vendor & Offshore Delivery:** Directed technical architecture, interface development, non-functional testing, and integration with offshore teams (TCS).

### 2011 – 03/2013 - Vice President, IT Enterprise Communications Manager Sr. - Zions Bancorporation — Salt Lake City, UT

- Managed teams overseeing enterprise communications infrastructure, including IVR, VoIP/telephony systems, networking, storage, and backup frameworks.

### 2004 – 2011 - Vice President, IT Manager - Zions Bancorporation — Salt Lake City, UT

- Led Data Transmission Services, Storage Infrastructure, and Distributed Enterprise Services across the corporation.
- Turned around teams flagged for material improvement, managing file transmission, data replication, authentication, email, and DR testing.

### **2000 – 2004 - IT Systems Engineer - Zions Bancorporation — Salt Lake City, UT**

- Supported data-center server environments, remote offices, and technical integration during the Zions & First Security merger.

### **1998 - 2000 - IT Consultant - Uinta Business Systems - Contractor to Zions Bancorporation and other Utah-based companies — Salt Lake City, UT**

- Provided systems administration, network design, and security consulting for Zions Bancorporation and regional clients.

## **Education & Community Leadership**

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**Bachelor of Science: Business Management** — University of Phoenix, Salt Lake City, UT (2009)

### **Executive & Community Involvement:**

- Co-Chair, Zions Bank Paint-a-Thon
- Member, Zions Peer Bank Forum (MAAG)
- Leadership Involvement, ZTC Building Committee

**References · Available on request.**